

Contributor Guide (Winter of Code Social)

Introduction

Welcome to **Winter of Code Social (WOCS)**! We're thrilled to have you join as a **Contributor**, the builders, coders, and creators behind every project. This guide explains how to find projects, contribute correctly, and ensure your pull requests (PRs) are counted toward the leaderboard.

Getting Started

Find Projects

Browse active WOCS projects and issues here: [Find Projects](#) (Use this link to discover open issues, their levels, and assigned mentors.)

Kick-Off Meeting

We're starting this season with a Kick-Off Meeting on Saturday, which is mandatory for all project admins. The meeting will be at 8 pm IST and 09:30 am CST on November 1. Please convert the time in your timezone to ensure you're a part of it. The link to join is in the newsletter.

If you're unable to attend live, that's okay, a recording will be shared afterward.

This session will include:

- An introduction to Winter of Code Social
- Contributor expectations and PR process walkthrough
- Q&A with mentors and admins

Registration & Eligibility

Before contributing, please ensure you are registered through the official event form:

 [Register for WOCS](#)

Note: If you contribute without registering, your name will **not appear on the leaderboard** and your PRs will **not count toward points**.

Contribution Points System

Your PR points are based on issue levels:

- **Level 1:** 2 points
- **Level 2:** 5 points
- **Level 3:** 11 points

Points are awarded **only after the PR is merged**, not when the issue is created or assigned.

Labeling Guidelines (Important)

To ensure your PR is tracked correctly, please follow these label rules:

✓ Correct Label Format:

- `wocs`
- `level 1 / level 2 / level 3`

✗ Incorrect Examples:

- `WOCS`, `Wocs`, `LEVEL 1`, `Level1`, `level1`, `Level 1` (double spaces)

Labels must be added before your PR is merged. Merging first without the correct labels may cause your points to be missed or miscalculated.

Leaderboard link: <https://woc.codesocial.tech/leaderboard>

(will be available once the event begins)

Evaluation and Level Assignment

- The level of each PR (1, 2, or 3) is assigned at the discretion of mentors or admins.
- Once a PR is merged, the assigned level is final and cannot be changed or appealed.
- Mentors' and admins' decisions are binding and conclusive to maintain fairness and consistency.

Best Practices

1. **Communicate:** Comment on issues before starting work to avoid duplicates.
2. **Follow Guidelines:** Each repo may have its own `README.md` and/or `CONTRIBUTING.md`, read it first.
3. **Stay Updated:** Join the Discord for real-time updates and mentor interactions.

4. **Celebrate Progress:** Share your merged PRs on LinkedIn or Discord using the hashtag **#WinterOfCodeSocial**.

Support

If you face any issues with anything, you can use any of these options to reach out to us:

- Post your query in the **#help** Discord channel
- Tag **@Team | Arushi** or **@Team | Rizwan on Discord** for help
- [Send us an email](#)